

3.3 Non-communicable diseases

In this section, an understanding of non-communicable diseases will be illustrated by reference to cancer, smoking-induced lung diseases and asthma.

Learners will use their knowledge of cell division from Module 3.1 to further their understanding of the cellular and genetic basis of cancer. The computerised technological devices and tests that enable early detection and diagnosis of cancer will also be considered, as well as the use of genetic screening to assess potential risks.

Consideration will be given to the analysis of epidemiological data when evaluating the causes of

non-infectious diseases, and learners will consider the importance of clinical trials when developing new medicinal treatments. The role of government health agencies in providing national guidelines for treatments is also explored.

In this section, learners will consider the biological and ethical implications of medical and scientific advancements and evaluate the associated risks and benefits to society.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.